the institute's remote location. "It was our best chance of going global. We were the first IIM that went whole hog into offering executive education, postgraduate programmes (PGP), in the digital mode," Chatterjee explains. Diversification was also aimed at expanding programme offerings. The Doctoral Programme in Management (PhD) is now into its 17th batch and is a full-time, residential, fully financially supported course. In 2019, IIM-K introduced the PhD (Practice Track) for working executives and the PGP in Business Leadership. The next year, it launched PGP in Liberal Studies and Management, which integrates management with humanities, as well as a full-time finance programme. In the diversity department, the institute's commitment to inclusion, particularly in its flagship PGPs, has gained attention. Female enrolment has risen steadily, with women making up 59 per cent of the current PGP batch—an impressive jump from a historic low of under 10 per cent. "Corporates vindicated my decision as the top three consulting firms like Bain, McKinsey and BCG hired equal numbers of male and female graduates, with women even outperforming in placements," Chatterjee says.

IIM-K's academic programmes are among the most extensive in the country. Its Management Development Programmes (MDPs) have benefitted around 41,000 participants from more than 150 organisations, including several Fortune 500 companies, over the past two decades. The Kochi satellite centre offers courses tailored for corporate executives, while the Faculty Development Programmes (FDPs) enhance management education infrastructure.

IIM-K has also received top-tier global accreditations. It was the first IIM to achieve AMBA accreditation in 2010, joining prestigious institutions like the London Business School and INSEAD. In 2021, it became the sixth management institution in India to earn the coveted EQUIS accreditation and, in 2024, it was re-accredited for five years. Besides, IIM-K's global rankings reflect its growing reputation. Its Executive MBA debuted in the QS World University Rankings in 2020 in the 101+ category, followed by its PGPs in 2021. In 2023, the Open Enrollment Programme entered the *Financial Times* Global Top 100, ranking 72, and climbed to rank 70 this year.

Looking ahead, IIM-K is focused on 'Vision 2047', as India approaches its 100th year of independence. Chatterjee describes the vision as "Globalising Indian thought," inspired by the achievements of Indians in global companies. "We believed Indian ideas had a certain resilience. Otherwise, how would Indians perform so well on the global stage? How would they leave their mark on companies like Microsoft, Google and Pepsi?" he asks.

IIM-K's philosophy is grounded in three guiding principles: *satyam* (authenticity), *nityam* (sustainability) and *purnam* (fulfilment), emphasising a responsible approach to leadership that is rarely practised in Indian business education. Prof. Deepa Sethi, Dean (Outreach, Executive Education and Internationalisation), Humanities and Liberal Arts in Management, who has called IIM-K home for 13 years, says: "My academic career has been enriched here, and I've felt empowered as a woman. I might not have had such an opportunity elsewhere."

At IIM-K, the butterflies and students alike bring colour and life to the campus, embodying the dreams and ambitions of a new generation ready to take flight. ■

STUDENTSPEAK



"Being on the IIM-K campus is a joy. The faculty is friendly, and the director is approachable and always welcoming. It's a great learning experience"

S. REABU KAILASH
Second-year MBA student

ALUMNISPEAK



"When I joined IIM-K, there were just too many uncertainties, which helped me shape my tolerance for ambiguity, a must trait for someone in the consulting industry"

SANDEEP CHATTERJEE
Supply Chain and Sustainability Leader, IBM Consulting

INDIAN INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT KOZHIKODE, KOZHIKODE

Established: *1996*

Campus size: *113 acres*

Director: *Professor Debashis Chatterjee*

Total students (first and second year): *985*

Share of female students: *43%*

Total faculty (permanent and visiting): *169*

Highest annual salary (domestic) earned by a student in 2024: *₹72.02 lakh*

Average annual salary (domestic) earned by students in 2024: *₹28.05 lakh*

Total number of recruiting companies in 2024: *156*

Total course fee (for two years): *₹19.72 lakh*

Placement record: *100% of students got jobs in 2024 and 2023*